

## Illustration of Visual Design Process Transcript

Now, we will be looking at categorisation of design visuals. When we spoke about the design goals, we said you have to use particular preattentive attributes or different types of graphs to bring out the best possible design so that the expressiveness and effectiveness of your visual art or the dashboard are very good. So, now we will try to understand what different types of elements that are there for you to achieve this purpose.

For example, there are six categories of design visuals that can be used to enhance the appeal of the dashboard or you use them in general to convey your information. First and foremost are the graphs. So, there are line graphs, bar graphs and area graphs.

We have seen in our earlier classes how effectively to use them depending upon the purpose at hand. So, these are visually presenting the quantitative information over a period of time or giving a comparison if there is a bar graph or an area graph or a stacked bar chart to show composition. There are different types of graphics that are typically trying to capture the basic insights about the quantity of data or a phenomenon that you want to capture.

You can use images to enhance the appeal of the dashboard. For example, you are talking about CO2 emissions, you can use deforestation or the climate change phenomenon extreme events as your illustrations to drive home that this is a very serious concern that you are trying to portray. So, if there are floods, you can show the flooding, this in the background as an icon in your dashboard which would naturally enhance the attentiveness of your reader and also bring the context to the data that you are trying to study.

For example, the graph here could have had a better context by simply having the life expectancy diagrams which show the health parameters and you can enhance the appeal of the visual. Similarly, you can use icons and these days these are very hot favourite for visual designing where you use icon for phenomenon. For example, in this graph instead of men and women, if you had the icons of man and woman the appeal could have been much more different.

Likewise, if you are talking about car production, you can use icons strategically in your visual to immediately convey the meaning that the particular graphic is trying to indicate. For example, when you are talking about car productions, instead of using a line graph, you can use an icon chart where you can show the number of cars as a horizontal bar clearly indicating one car with 10 lakh units or something so that people can immediately see that this is car production. And you can also see CO2 emissions along with car production and interact them to clearly drive home the point increasing car production or usage of cars will lead to higher CO2 emissions using certain icons.

Icons and images draw the attention and provide additional context for the audience to decipher the data. Then you have drawing objects which are geometrical shapes that are used within the data dashboard to indicate relationship between graphics or within the graph. So, in the experiential learning session, we will see the usage of each of the six categories to enhance the expressiveness and effectiveness of the visual and text we have already discussed.

Text is one of the best ways to highlight and portray information that you want to convey to the audience. In the dashboard design, the pop-up box which is nothing but a textual element coming on the graphic. For example, the earlier dashboard when you select on Belgium, this is a pop-up box, nothing but a textual element containing four pieces of information saying that this is country Belgium indicating the woman legend, the orange dot saying woman and 25.9 being the ages years of life expectancy for women and this is captured in a simple text which is coming out as a pop-up.

So, these elements can enhance the appeal of your visual and most importantly can bring in the insight that you want to drive to the audience in a more effective manner. And then you have organisers especially the small multiples, tables and spatial maps which will help you to better present your data which is otherwise widespread. Let us take the example of GDP growth rates across the country.

It could be presented on a spatial map giving a feeling of how growth rates compare with other countries very intuitively. The same could not be achieved by using a bar graph or a table. You can use small multiples depending upon the use case where there are multiple categories and the same phenomenon has to be observed across all of them.

In these cases, small multiples might be very useful. So, depending upon the purpose at hand, you might be using design visuals to enhance the expressiveness and effectiveness of your dashboard.

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